

Nickolas J. Hilton

Senior Software Engineer with 8+ years of experience, specializing in Front End Development

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EXPERIENCE

Datadog 2023 - 2026 <i>Software Engineer II</i>	Software Catalog Utilized React, TypeScript, and Golang to attach metadata like on-call and runbooks to services. Built novel graph-first views to highlight observed relations and hierarchies between services and systems. Worked with customers to craft user personas and rapidly prototype/iterate an Internal Developer Portal. Led a team of three frontend engineers to build the above prototype into production-ready experiences. Built developer hub product to act on reviewed PRs, address unhealthy services, and respond to incidents. Introduced user metrics that track and optimize for user journeys within Software Catalog. Drove performance improvement initiatives, shaving seconds off first render with prefetching/pagination. Rearchitected data fetchers to reduce prop-drilling and throttle expensive renders/calculations. Prototyped AI-driven system curation based on observed telemetry and LLM-generated descriptions.
Meta 2020 - 2022 <i>Software Engineer (E4)</i>	Deployment UX Created monitoring platform for Meta’s internal container and sharding solutions. Utilized React, Recoil, Hack, and GraphQL to deliver key customer features that expedite debugging. Developed novel and interactive charts for efficiently visualizing and drilling down data at scale. Created widget framework for detecting/surfacing known errors, their culprit deployments, and fixes. Utilized Chrome DevTools and backend query profilers to identify bottlenecks in our application. Adopted prefetching to improve page loads while removing painful tech debt. Messenger Desktop Developed front-end messaging and real-time communication features in React Native. Created C++-based native modules for interfacing directly with users’ operating systems. Migrated DOM-dependent features from Electron to React Native, reducing memory/start time.
Google 2017 - 2020 <i>Software Engineer (L4)</i>	Google Cloud Common Frontend Components Developed and maintained a library of common Angular components used by 400+ frontend devs. Drove Karma screenshot test adoption and improvements until they matched integration test quality. Karma improvements reduced flakiness and cut test time from 20 minutes to 30 seconds. Explored and improved performance of critical and historically slow components. Created generic virtualization component for rendering 50k+ rows of variably sized data. Drove the cross-org publication of components to the wider company in a multi-quarter plan. Plan included beta test groups to mitigate risk and tech debt, prioritizing team velocity. Supported product-wide transition from JavaScript and AngularJS to TypeScript and Angular. Hosted 5 interns and mentored 3 new hires.
Microsoft 2015, 2016 <i>Software Engineer Intern</i>	Windows Desktop Shell Prototyped a start menu widget for managing contacts in C++/CX. Created Universal Windows App to create and validate JSON for Windows 10 notifications.

EDUCATION

Rochester Institute of Technology B.S. in Computer Science December 2016

Skills: TypeScript, JavaScript, Golang, Python, HTML, CSS, React, React Native, Angular, AngularJS, Recoil, GraphQL
Focus Areas: Frontend architecture, data visualization, performance optimization, developer tooling & internal developer portals